



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ireland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great question, and it's awesome that you're thinking about your future early on. Since you're 16, you've just completed *folkeskolen* in Denmark, and you now have a few clear educational paths to choose from. Here's a breakdown of the most common options in Denmark after 9th or 10th grade, along with some advice tailored to your background and potential interests:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These programs prepare you for higher education (university or professional bachelor programs). There are several types:

A. STX (Studentereksamen) – General Upper Secondary

- **Focus:** Broad academic subjects including sciences, humanities, and languages.
- **Good for:** If you're still unsure what you want to study later or want to keep many doors open.
- **Why you might like it:** Strong foundation for university and you're already bilingual (Danish + English/Irish background).

B. HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)

- **Focus:** Business, economics, and languages.
- **Good for:** If you're interested in business, marketing, or international trade.
- **Why you might like it:** Your Irish background might give you an edge if you're interested in international business or working across countries.

C. HTX (Higher Technical Examination)

- **Focus:** Technology, natural sciences, and engineering.
- **Good for:** If you like hands-on science, IT, or engineering.
- **Why you might like it:** Great prep if you're curious about technical fields or the environment.

D. HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)

- **Focus:** Shorter (2-year) program, more practical and adult-oriented.
- **Good for:** If you want a shorter route to some types of higher education or need a less demanding structure.
- **Why you might like it:** Some find HF easier to manage if they want a quicker way to move on to further studies or work.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – EUD)

- **Focus:** Prepares you for a job directly (e.g., electrician, chef, carpenter, social worker).
- **Good for:** If you enjoy practical work or want to get into the workforce sooner.
- **Why you might like it:** You can combine work and school with an apprenticeship (*praktik*), and still have the option to take a *eux* track, which gives you a degree equivalent to a gymnasial exam.

Bonus: International Options

Since your parents are from Ireland, you might:

- **Study part of your program abroad** through exchange (e.g., Erasmus).
- **Consider International Baccalaureate (IB)** in Denmark if offered nearby – it's in English and recognized worldwide.

My Recommendations (Based on You)

Since you're bilingual, open-minded, and fresh from *folkeskolen*, consider these paths:

1. **STX** – Keeps all your options open and fits well with both a Danish and international outlook.
2. **IB** – If you're academically strong and interested in a global education, it's a fantastic springboard for university in Denmark, Ireland, or elsewhere.
3. **HHX or HTX** – If you already know you're into business or tech.
4. **EUX** – If you like practical learning but also want the option of going to university later.

Next Steps

- Visit **uddannelsesguiden.dk (UG.dk)** – Denmark's official education guide.
- Talk to a guidance counselor at your school or a local **Studievalg** center.
- Try visiting open house events (*åbent hus*) at schools you're interested in.

If you tell me more about what you're interested in (e.g., science, art, tech, people), I can give even more specific advice. Want to dive deeper into that?